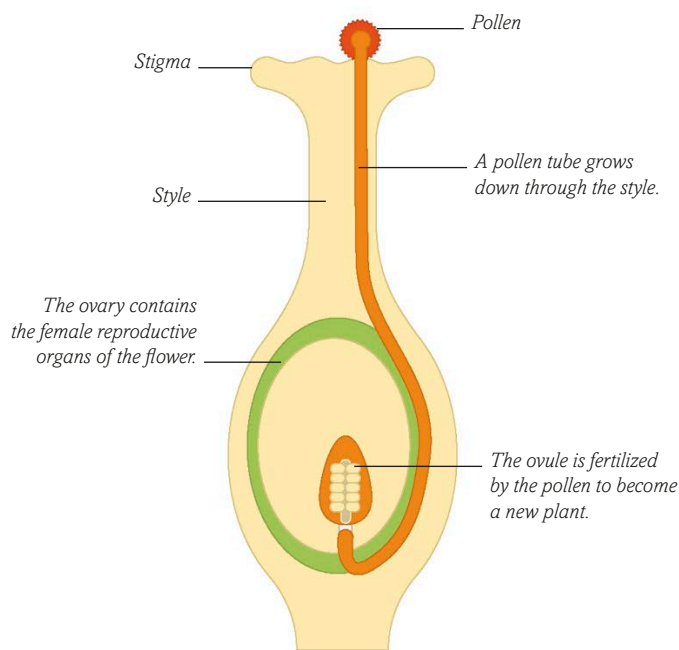




What is a flower?

Many plants rely on animals, such as bees and hummingbirds, to help them reproduce. To attract these animals, many plants have flowers that are brightly colored, have a sweet scent, and produce a sugary nectar for them to eat. When the animal visits the flower to find the nectar, it becomes covered in pollen. The animal, known as a pollinator, then transports the pollen to another flower.

Fertilization



When pollen lands on a flower's stigma, it grows a tiny tube that travels through the style, taking the male pollen cells to the ovary. The male cells join with female cells, in the ovules, which become the seeds. This process is called fertilization.

Stigma ➤ This is the female part of the flower and has either a sticky tip or fine hairs to trap pollen.

Pollen ➤ The fine yellow grains of pollen, found on a tubular structure called an anther, contain the plant's male sex cells.

Stamen ➤ Each stamen has a long filament with an anther on the top where the pollen is produced.

Petals ➤ Colorful, often scented, petals attract pollinating animals to the flower. Petals come in all shapes and sizes and often look brighter to insect eyes than to human eyes.

Pollination

A tiger lily has colorful petals and sugary nectar for animals such as this bee to eat. As it feeds, the bee brushes against the pollen, which sticks to its body. Pollen contains male cells. When the bee visits another tiger lily, the pollen will brush onto the new flower's stigma, and grow towards the female cells. This is called pollination.